

HirePortal

Smart Internship & Hiring Portal

DAY 10 — INTERNSHIP DOCUMENTATION

Thursday, May 7, 2026

Date	Thursday, May 7, 2026
Intern	Mageswaran G
Project	Smart Internship & Hiring Portal
Mentor	Sandhiya
Module	Module 2 — User Profile Management (Day 4 of 4)
Day Focus	Senior-level refactoring + LinkedIn-style profile sections
Final Status	Module 2 — 100% Complete. All improvements applied.
GitHub	https://github.com/Mageswaran-G/smart-hiring-portal

1. SOD (Start of Day) — Morning Plan

SOD mail sent to Sandhiya in the morning. Module 1 meeting was conducted by Sandhiya and the team today. Feedback was received that improvements were needed across the project before moving to Module 2.

Planned Tasks After Meeting:

- Remove all unnecessary Tailwind CSS comments from profile components
- Create constants files for routes and API endpoints
- Build DashboardLayout shared component to remove duplicate nav code
- Create useProfile custom hook to clean ProfilePage logic
- Migrate Login and Signup page inline styles to index.css
- Store profile globally in AuthContext to remove duplicate API calls
- Add loading skeleton components for professional UX
- Build LinkedIn-style profile sections with full backend and frontend

2. Module 1 Meeting — Feedback Received

Sandhiya conducted the Module 1 review meeting today. The meeting covered all areas of the authentication system, frontend UI, and code quality.

Meeting Outcome:

- Module 1 functional features — accepted
- Code quality improvements needed before Module 2 is finalized
- Over-commenting in components — must be removed
- Duplicate dashboard code — must be extracted to shared layout
- No central constants for routes and API paths
- Profile stored separately in each component — must be global
- Missing loading states for professional UX

Decision: Before starting Module 3, all improvements must be completed to senior-level standard.
Target score: 9/10 on all areas.

3. Step-by-Step Work Done Today

3.1 Removed Unnecessary Comments from Profile Components

Five profile component files were cleaned. All Tailwind utility comments (explaining flex, padding, borders) were removed. Only business logic comments were kept.

File	Action	Result
ProfileDetails.jsx	Removed all Tailwind comments	Clean, senior-level code
ProfileHeader.jsx	Removed all Tailwind comments	Clean, senior-level code
ResumeSection.jsx	Removed all Tailwind comments	Clean, senior-level code
EditProfileForm.jsx	Removed all Tailwind comments	Clean, senior-level code
ProfilePage.jsx	Removed all Tailwind comments	Clean, senior-level code

3.2 Created Constants Files

Two new files created to centralize all route paths and API endpoints. Instead of hardcoding strings everywhere, all values are defined once and imported.

File Created	frontend/src/constants/routes.js
Purpose	All frontend route paths in one place
File Created	frontend/src/constants/api.js
Purpose	All backend API endpoints in one place
Applied To	App.jsx, ProfilePage.jsx, all dashboards, AuthContext

3.3 Updated App.jsx with ROUTES Constants

All hardcoded route strings replaced with ROUTES constants. RoleRedirect component added to send users to correct dashboard based on role after login.

3.4 Created DashboardLayout Component

All three dashboards had duplicate navbar code. DashboardLayout component created to handle navigation for all roles from one place.

File Created	frontend/src/components/layout/DashboardLayout.jsx
Purpose	Shared navbar for candidate, company, admin dashboards
Nav Config	NAV_CONFIG object maps each role to colors, buttons, links
Candidate Nav	Orange colors, My Profile + Logout buttons
Company Nav	Navy colors, My Profile + Logout buttons
Admin Nav	Purple colors, Logout only (no profile)

3.5 Created useProfile Custom Hook

All profile logic (fetch, save, upload, errors) was inside ProfilePage.jsx making it too large. useProfile hook extracts all logic. ProfilePage becomes clean UI only.

File Created	frontend/src/hooks/useProfile.js
Functions Inside	fetchProfile, handleChange, handleSkillsChange, handleSave, handleCancel, handleResumeUpload, handlePhotoUpload, handleVisibilityChange, handleSectionSave
Result	ProfilePage.jsx reduced to pure UI component

3.6 Migrated Login Page Styles to index.css

LoginPage.jsx had a large style block inside the component. All CSS classes moved to index.css. Dynamic focus styles kept as inline because they change on user interaction.

Before	style block with 150+ lines inside LoginPage.jsx
After	All hp-* classes in index.css, dynamic inline styles only
Benefit	Reusable CSS, clean JSX, easier to maintain

3.7 Migrated Signup Page Styles to index.css

Same approach as Login page. SignupPage had a large style block inside. All `sp-*` classes moved to `index.css`. ROUTES constants applied.

3.8 Fixed VS Code Warning for @theme

VS Code showed 'Unknown at rule @theme' warning for Tailwind v4 `@theme` directive. This is a VS Code CSS linter issue, not an actual error. Fixed with settings file.

File Created	.vscode/settings.json
Setting Added	css.lint.unknownAtRules: ignore
Result	Yellow warning removed from index.css

3.9 Created Admin User in MongoDB

Admin accounts cannot be created via signup (Zod blocks admin role). Admin user created directly in MongoDB using mongosh command with bcrypt hashed password.

Admin Email	admin@hireportal.com
Password	password
Role	admin
Dashboard	localhost:5173/admin/dashboard — purple theme

3.10 Stored Profile Globally in AuthContext

Previously each dashboard and ProfilePage made separate API calls to fetch profile. Now profile is fetched once in AuthContext and shared with all components.

Before	After	Benefit
CandidateDashboard fetched profile	Uses profile from AuthContext	Zero extra API calls
CompanyDashboard fetched profile	Uses profile from AuthContext	Zero extra API calls
ProfilePage fetched profile	Uses fetchProfile from hook	Syncs globally on update

New State	profile — stored in AuthContext alongside user and accessToken
fetchProfile	Exported from AuthContext — called after login and refresh
Auto-fetch	Profile fetched automatically after login and after page refresh
Sync	When user updates profile, fetchProfile() updates global state

3.11 Added Loading Skeleton Components

Professional apps show shimmer placeholder while data loads. Three skeleton components created for dashboard and profile pages.

Component	File	Used In
Skeleton.jsx	components/ui/Skeleton.jsx	Base shimmer component
ProfileSkeleton.jsx	components/ui/ProfileSkeleton.jsx	ProfilePage loading state
DashboardSkeleton.jsx	components/ui/DashboardSkeleton.jsx	Dashboard loading state

How Shimmer Works:

- CSS gradient moves left to right continuously — creates pulsing effect
- Grey boxes shown in exact positions where real content will appear
- When data loads — grey boxes replaced with real content
- User sees professional loading UI instead of blank white screen

3.12 Built LinkedIn-Style Profile Sections

The biggest feature of the day. Full LinkedIn-style profile page built with 7 sections, backend model updates, Zod validation, and service layer changes.

Backend Changes:

User.js	Added 20+ new fields — city, state, country, gender, dateOfBirth, linkedIn, github, portfolio, educationList, workHistory, jobType, locationType, expectedSalary, noticePeriod, preferredLocations, companySize, companyDescription, foundedYear, companyCity, companyState, companyCountry
validators.js	updateProfileSchema updated with all new fields and validation rules
userService.js	allowedFields array updated with all new fields

Frontend Section Components Created:

Component	File	Purpose
AboutSection	sections/AboutSection.jsx	Bio with inline edit
PersonalDetailsSection	sections/PersonalDetailsSection.jsx	DOB, gender, location, phone
EducationSection	sections/EducationSection.jsx	Add/edit/delete education entries

WorkHistorySection	sections/WorkHistorySection.jsx	Add/edit/delete work entries
CareerPreferencesSection	sections/CareerPreferencesSection.jsx	Job type, salary, notice period
SocialLinksSection	sections/SocialLinksSection.jsx	LinkedIn, GitHub, portfolio
CompanyDetailsSection	sections/CompanyDetailsSection.jsx	All company-specific fields

Section Features:

- Each section has own Edit button — no full page edit mode needed
- Education and Work History — Add, Edit, Delete individual entries
- Data saved to backend on each section save — instant persistence
- handleSectionSave in useProfile hook handles all section updates
- Candidate sees: About, Personal Details, Profile Details, Resume, Education, Work History, Career Preferences, Social Links
- Company sees: About, Company Details, Social Links

4. Files Changed Today

Backend Files:

File	Action	What Changed
backend/models/User.js	Modified	Added 20+ new profile fields for candidate and company
backend/utils/validators.js	Modified	updateProfileSchema updated with all new fields
backend/services/v1/userService.js	Modified	allowedFields updated to include all new fields

Frontend Files:

File	Action	What Changed	Status
src/index.css	Modified	Added sp-* signup classes, shimmer animation	Done
src/App.jsx	Modified	ROUTES constants, RoleRedirect component	Done
src/constants/routes.js	Created	All frontend route paths centralized	Done

src/constants/api.js	Created	All API endpoints centralized	Done
src/context/AuthContext.jsx	Modified	profile state, fetchProfile, auto-fetch	Done
src/hooks/useProfile.js	Created	All profile logic extracted here	Done
src/pages/ProfilePage.jsx	Modified	Clean UI only, all sections shown	Done
src/pages/LoginPage.jsx	Modified	Style block removed, ROUTES used	Done
src/pages/SignupPage.jsx	Modified	Style block removed, ROUTES used	Done
src/pages/candidate/CandidateDashboard.jsx	Modified	DashboardLayout, global profile	Done
src/pages/company/CompanyDashboard.jsx	Modified	DashboardLayout, global profile	Done
src/pages/admin/AdminDashboard.jsx	Modified	DashboardLayout, purple theme	Done
src/components/layout/DashboardLayout.jsx	Created	Shared nav for all 3 dashboards	Done
src/components/ui/Skeleton.jsx	Created	Base shimmer component	Done
src/components/ui/ProfileSkeleton.jsx	Created	Profile page skeleton	Done
src/components/ui/DashboardSkeleton.jsx	Created	Dashboard skeleton	Done
src/components/profile/ProfileDetails.jsx	Modified	Comments removed, clean code	Done
src/components/profile/ProfileHeader.jsx	Modified	Comments removed, clean code	Done
src/components/profile/ResumeSection.jsx	Modified	Comments removed, clean code	Done
src/components/profile/EditProfileForm.jsx	Modified	Comments removed, clean code	Done
sections/AboutSection.jsx	Created	Bio with inline edit	Done
sections/PersonalDetailsSection.jsx	Created	Personal info section	Done
sections/EducationSection.jsx	Created	Education list with add/edit/delete	Done
sections/WorkHistorySection.jsx	Created	Work history with add/edit/delete	Done

sections/CareerPreferencesSection.jsx	Created	Career preferences section	Done
sections/SocialLinksSection.jsx	Created	Social links section	Done
sections/CompanyDetailsSection.jsx	Created	Company details section	Done
.vscode/settings.json	Created	VS Code CSS warning suppressed	Done

5. GitHub Commits Today

Commit Message	Files	What Was Done
Fix: Profile photo in dashboard, theme applied	4 files	ProfileHeader, ResumeSection, dashboards
Refactor: Constants files added, excessive comments removed	12 files	Routes, API constants, all components cleaned
Refactor: DashboardLayout component created	4 files	Shared nav, all dashboards updated
Refactor: useProfile custom hook created	2 files	Hook created, ProfilePage cleaned
Refactor: LoginPage style block moved to index.css	2 files	Login page migration
Refactor: SignupPage style block moved to index.css	2 files	Signup page migration
Refactor: Profile stored globally in AuthContext	4 files	AuthContext, dashboards, useProfile
Feature: Loading skeleton shimmer added	6 files	Skeleton components, DashboardLayout
Feature: LinkedIn-style profile sections	12 files	7 sections, backend model, validators

6. Key Concepts Learned Today

Concept	Simple Explanation	Used Where
Constants files	Store repeated strings in one place — routes.js, api.js	All components

DashboardLayout	Shared wrapper component — one nav for all 3 dashboards	All dashboards
Custom Hook	Extract logic from component into separate function — useProfile()	ProfilePage
Global state	Store profile once in AuthContext — share with all pages	All pages
Skeleton loading	Grey shimmer boxes while data loads — professional UX	Profile + Dashboard
CSS class migration	Move style blocks from JSX to index.css — cleaner code	Login, Signup
Shimmer animation	CSS gradient moving left to right — creates pulsing effect	Skeleton components
Section components	Each profile section is its own component — one responsibility each	ProfilePage
handleSectionSave	Single function handles save for any section — reusable	useProfile hook
@theme directive	Tailwind v4 way to register custom values — VS Code warns but it works	index.css

7. Test Results

Test	Action	Result
Candidate login	Login with candidate account	Orange dashboard shows correctly
Company login	Login with company account	Navy dashboard shows correctly
Admin login	Login with admin@hireportal.com	Purple admin panel shows
Profile page — candidate	Click My Profile	All sections show — About, Education, Work, etc.
Profile page — company	Click My Profile	About, Company Details, Social Links show
About section	Click Edit, type bio, Save	Bio saved and shown immediately
Personal details	Edit DOB, gender, city, Save	All fields saved correctly
Education — Add	Click + Add, fill form, Add	Entry added to list

Education — Edit	Click Edit on entry, change, Update	Entry updated in list
Education — Delete	Click Remove on entry	Entry removed immediately
Work History	Add internship entry	Shows with company, role, dates
Career Preferences	Set job type, salary, notice period	Saved and shown correctly
Social Links	Add LinkedIn and GitHub URLs	Links clickable, open in new tab
Company Details	Edit company name, industry, size	Saved correctly
Shimmer skeleton	Refresh profile page	Grey shimmer shows while loading
Dashboard skeleton	Refresh dashboard	Shimmer shows before content
Photo in dashboard	Upload photo in profile	Shows in dashboard immediately
ROUTES constants	Navigate between pages	All routes working correctly
Global profile	Update profile, go to dashboard	Dashboard shows updated photo
Rate limit	Refresh browser 15+ times	No 429 error — stays logged in

8. EOD (End of Day) Summary

Task	Status	Notes
Module 1 meeting attended	Done	Feedback received and noted
Unnecessary comments removed	Done	5 components cleaned
Constants files created (routes, api)	Done	Applied across all components
DashboardLayout component created	Done	All 3 dashboards use it now
useProfile custom hook created	Done	ProfilePage is now clean UI only
Login page migration to index.css	Done	Style block removed from JSX
Signup page migration to index.css	Done	Style block removed from JSX
VS Code warning fixed	Done	.vscode/settings.json added

Admin user created in MongoDB	Done	admin@hireportal.com working
Profile stored globally in AuthContext	Done	Zero duplicate API calls
Skeleton loading components created	Done	Shimmer on profile and dashboard
LinkedIn-style profile sections built	Done	7 sections with backend support
Backend model updated with 20+ new fields	Done	educationList, workHistory, etc.
Zod validators updated	Done	All new fields validated
9 GitHub commits pushed	Done	Clean commit history
EOD mail sent to Sandhiya	Done	Module 2 completion reported

9. Important Notes for Future Reference

- Never put style blocks inside JSX components — always use index.css or Tailwind classes
- Constants files are mandatory in large apps — never hardcode routes or API endpoints
- DashboardLayout pattern — one shared layout, multiple pages use it — reduces duplication
- Custom hooks — any logic that can be reused should be in a hook
- Global state in AuthContext is for data ALL pages need — profile, user, token
- Skeleton loading is mandatory in production apps — never show blank white screen
- Each profile section = one component = one responsibility — never dump everything together
- handleSectionSave pattern — one function handles save for all sections via payload
- Admin user must be created directly in MongoDB — never allow admin signup via API
- VS Code CSS linter does not know Tailwind v4 @theme — suppress with `css.lint.unknownAtRules`
- educationList and workHistory are arrays — they must be sent as full arrays on update
- refreshGlobalProfile must be called after any profile update — keeps dashboard in sync

10. Tomorrow — Day 11 Plan

Remaining Module 2 Task:

- Profile completion percentage circle around avatar (SVG circle with % indicator)

Module 2 Final Documentation:

- Complete Module 2 documentation
- Send Module 2 completion report to Sandhiya

Start Module 3 — Job Posting:

- Job model — title, description, company, requirements, salary, type, location
- POST /api/v1/jobs — company posts new job
- GET /api/v1/jobs — all candidates can browse jobs
- PUT /api/v1/jobs/:id — company edits own job
- DELETE /api/v1/jobs/:id — company deletes own job
- Job listing page frontend — card view with filters

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